

LEAVE POLICY

Objective

The objective of the leave policy is to encourage employees to take planned leave in order to:

- Take a break from work
- Recharge themselves
- Rejuvenate for enhanced work performance

Applicability

These rules shall be applicable to all employees located in India.

Leave Year

The recording year for all types of leave entitlement will be the English calendar year, i.e., from **1st January to 31st December**.

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A. Type of Leaves

1. Earned Leave (EL)

(a) Employees shall be eligible for **18 days Earned Leave per calendar year**, credited at the rate of **1.5 days per month**.

Intervening Saturdays, Sundays, and holidays will not be counted as part of Earned Leave.

(b) Employees who have not completed twelve (12) months of continuous service shall be granted pro-rated Earned Leave.

(c) Leave applications must be submitted at least **three (3) days in advance** using the prescribed leave application process.

(d) Leave applications for periods exceeding **ten (10) days** should be submitted at least **two (2) weeks in advance**. Any exception requires line manager approval.

(e) If an employee needs to extend leave due to unforeseen circumstances, approval must be obtained from the manager. Upon returning to work, the employee must submit a leave application covering the extended period.

(f) Employees are responsible for contacting their immediate manager/supervisor immediately if urgent leave is required.

Urgent Leave is defined as leave requested:

- On the actual day of absence, or
- One day prior to the absence

Such requests must be supported by a reasonable explanation.

(g) Employees may carry forward unutilized leave balances up to a maximum of **one year's entitlement**.

(h) Encashment of accumulated leave balances is permitted only at the time of resignation.

For leave encashment calculations:

- One month = 26 days
- Salary considered = Last drawn salary (Basic + HRA)

(i) Taking Earned Leave during the notice period is subject to management approval.

If an employee has consumed leave in excess of Earned Leave entitlement, the employee shall reimburse the Company for the excess leave taken at the time of separation.

2. Sick Leave (SL)

(a) Employees shall be eligible for **twelve (12) days Sick Leave** per completed calendar year of service.

Intervening Saturdays, Sundays, and holidays will not be counted as part of Sick Leave.

Medical certificates must be submitted if Sick Leave exceeds **three consecutive days**.

(b) Unused Sick Leave:

- Cannot be encashed
- Cannot be carried forward to the next year

3. Parental Leave

Maternity Leave (ML)

(a) For all female employees, maternity leave and benefits shall be granted in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act.

(b) Female employees shall be entitled to:

- 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for up to 2 children
- 12 weeks of paid maternity leave if already having 2 or more children

(c) Female employees should, wherever possible, submit maternity leave applications at least **six weeks before commencement** to facilitate alternative work arrangements.

(d) In the case of adoption of a child below the age of 3 months:

- 12 weeks adoption leave shall be granted

(e) In case of surrogacy:

- The commissioning mother is entitled to **12 weeks leave** from the date of handover of the child.

The above guidelines should be read in conjunction with the Maternity Benefit Act.

Other Parental Leave

Employees (other than those entitled to maternity leave) who have completed **one (1) year of service** are eligible for:

- **5 days (1 week) fully paid parental leave**, and
- **15 working days (3 weeks) at 80% base pay**

Parental leave must be taken within **one year of the child's birth or adoption**.

The above benefit should be read in line with Global Guidelines on Parental Leave.

4. Leave Without Pay

(a) Generally, Leave Without Pay is not allowed.

However, the Company may, at its sole discretion, grant Leave Without Pay for strong and valid reasons on a case-by-case basis.

Approvals required:

- Immediate Manager
- Departmental Manager
- HR Head

(b) Holidays and weekly offs falling within the Leave Without Pay period:

- Will not be paid
- Salary will not be credited for the entire Leave Without Pay duration

5. Paid Day Off

If an employee is required to work on a:

- Public Holiday, or
- Sunday

the employee shall be entitled to a Paid Day Off, mutually agreed between the employee and supervisor depending on operational requirements.

B. General Guidelines

- Sanction of leave is always subject to work requirements and management discretion.
- Prefix and suffix of weekly holidays or company-declared holidays are permitted.
- Except in emergencies, Earned Leave cannot be availed without prior approval.
- In emergencies, the Company must receive written communication within three days.
- Continued absence for more than three days without intimation will be deemed major misconduct and may result in termination of service.
- Leave requiring proportionate calculation will be rounded off to the nearest number.
- Holidays and weekly offs falling in between any type of leave (except Leave Without Pay, Maternity Leave, or Parental Leave) will not be counted as leave days.
- Management decisions regarding interpretation of these rules shall be final and binding.
- Management reserves the sole discretion to amend or alter these rules from time to time without prior notice.